



Covering marginalized communities

NEWS REPORTING TIPS

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How/why I came to the beat:

- my background
- expertise, access
- USCRI story

EARLY SOURCING EFFORTS

Vermont Afghans celebrate Nowruz, hope for a sweet future

By Auditi Guha
March 19, 2023, 11:05 pm



Men dance as Afghan families from around the state gather in Burlington on Sunday, March 19, 2023, to celebrate Nowruz, a holiday that marks the start of spring and new year in Afghanistan. Photo by Glenn Russell/VTDigger

First African Landing Day event in Burlington celebrates Black faith, resilience and creativity

By Auditi Guha
August 28, 2022, 4:47 pm



Pepole cheer for gospel performer Essential Praise at the Vermont First African Landing Day 2022 commemoration in Burlington on Saturday August 27, 2022. Photo by Glenn Russell/VTDigger

With bus drivers in short supply, Winooski's immigrant parents take the wheel

By Auditi Guha
December 29, 2022, 6:17 am



SOURCING TIPS

- Census data
- Multicultural events
- Community centers
- Organizations
- Local groups
- Movers and shakers



Mark Hughes, with the group Justice for All, leads marchers in song in St. Albans on Saturday. I

WHAT IS EQUITY?



“Equity seeks to ensure respect and equal opportunity for all, using all resources and tools to elevate the voices of under-represented and/or disadvantaged groups.”

–The Pulitzer Center

WHY DO WE CARE?

- Human dignity
- Democracy
- Balance
- Fairness
- Due diligence
- POGM

We believe that all human beings have dignity, that cruelty is never justified, and that power must be held to account; that a multiracial, multicultural democracy requires vigilant and consistent reporting on the rights and experiences of all people...

-- COLUMBIA JOURNALISM SCHOOL



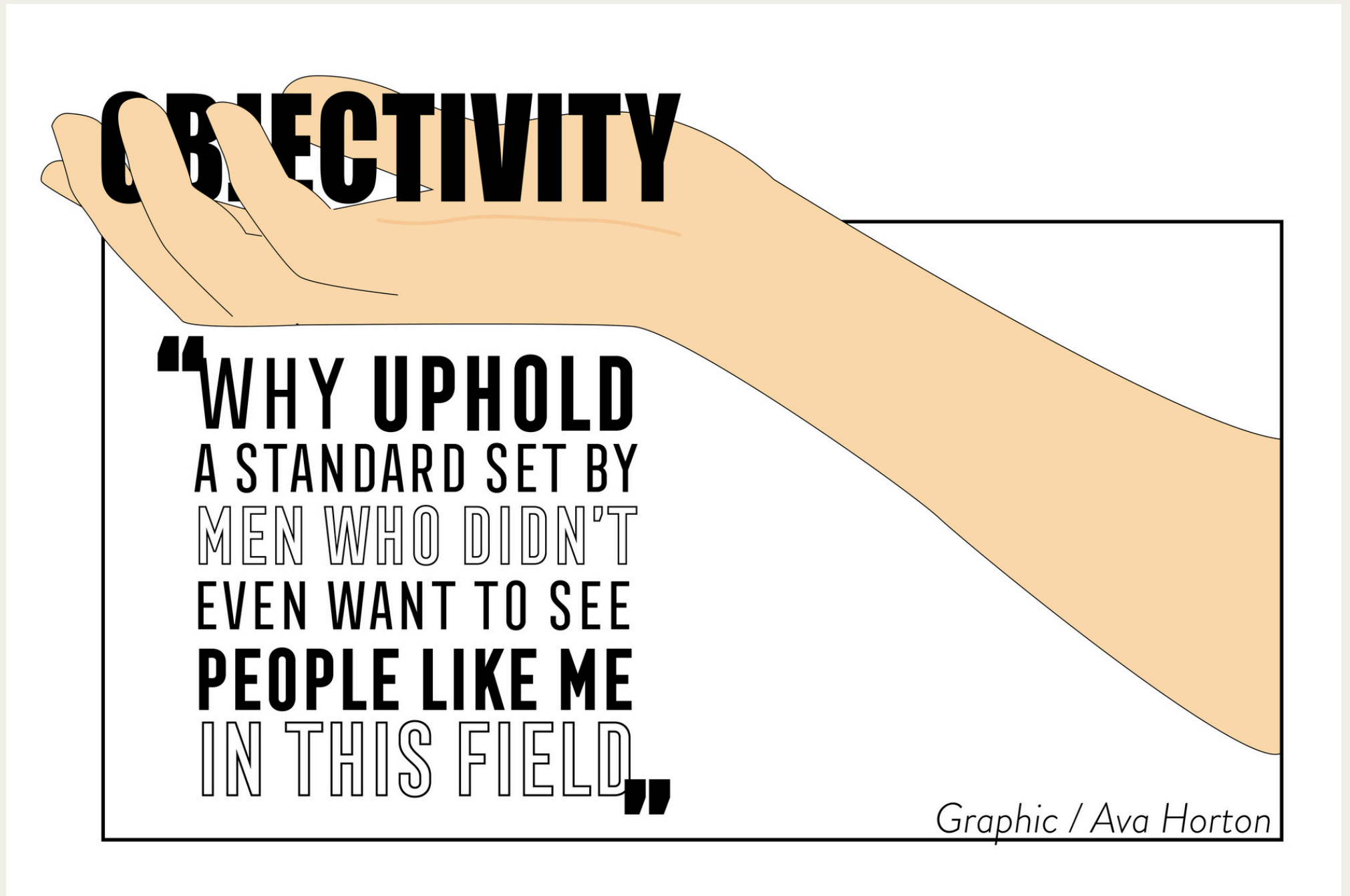
MARGINALIZED COMMUNITIES

- Those excluded from mainstream social, economic, educational, and/or cultural life.
- Due to race, gender identity, sexual orientation, age, physical ability, language, immigration status.
- They face unique forms of discrimination and violence.
- They have often been historically harmed.
- Distrust of or no relationship with media.



THE MYTH OF OBJECTIVITY

- Objectivity has always been something inaccessible to a lot of people.
- Who created this standard for journalism?
- Did it consider systemic racism and how MP continue to be discriminated - housing, health jobs, education?
- A commitment to appear objective could cause further harm.



HUMANITY FIRST

- Ask questions
- Do the research
- Cultural norms
- Establish trust
- Anonymity
- Do the soft stories
- Invest time
- Break bread/drink tea
- Educate your newsroom



Wardak Karimi poured tea for guests — an Afghan tradition — at his Shelburne house on a recent fall afternoon.

Photo by Auditi Guha/VTDigger

SOFT STORIES



Some Vermont schools mark Diwali as a school holiday for the 1st time

By Auditi Guha November 1, 2024, 3:47 pm



Westbury Village residents seek ‘fair and equitable water rates’ from Champlain Water District

By Auditi Guha December 23, 2024, 4:23 pm



Winooski to consider ‘sanctuary school’ policy to protect immigrant students

By Auditi Guha January 3, 2025, 5:16 pm



‘I had to shut down’: Student who endured persistent racism at Woodstock school wins settlement against district, supervisory union

By Auditi Guha January 27, 2025, 6:58 am



WPTZ

<https://www.mynbc5.com> › article › vt-mountain-views...

Mountain Views Supervisory Union settles in discrimination ...

Jan 29, 2025 — A complaint filed by his mother, **Jaya** Holliman, in 2022, said the school district discriminated against him in terms of accommodations.



ATLANTA BLACK STAR

‘Was So Overwhelmed with All the Comments’: Black Vermont Student Who Was Bombarded with Racist Bullying, Compared to a ‘Chimpanzee’ and ‘Runaway Slave’ Wins \$175K Settlement

By Jill Jordan Sieder | Published on: January 29, 2025 | Updated on January 30, 2025 | Comments (0)

IMPACT/FOLLOW UP



Petition seeks removal of superintendent in wake of Woodstock school racism case

By Auditi Guha February 12, 2025, 7:11 pm

Good morning, Auditi, I read your story on discrimination at Woodstock High School yesterday and it continues to haunt me. I live in Barnard. Our young people attend junior and senior high school in Woodstock. Not so many years ago a mixed race family had to make the choice to leave the community because of the harassment their son was suffering at the school. I also know of issues of being cruel to each other and the victims not having the support of the teachers and administration.

Dear Auditi,
Thank you so much for the excellent coverage of Ms. Holliman and her son. I live in the Upper Valley but was unaware of this deeply troubling story.

In the face of the new presidential administration, your role as Equity Reporter and Editor and coverage of equity issues is vital and I thank you for your work.

Warmly,
Eric

OPINION

Robert L. Walsh: Racial harassment in Vermont public schools is a continuing problem

I believe we should address the problem of racial harassment by teaching African American history in Vermont's schools

February 14, 2025, 7:01 am

CENTER THEIR VOICES/EXPERIENCE



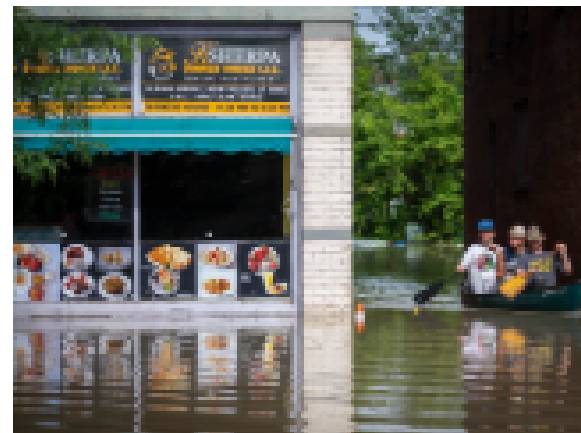
A student's death sparks questions about support services at Middlebury College

By Auditi Guha December 22, 2023, 3:29 pm



'I don't need help; I need customers': Immigrant-owned businesses still face hurdles to flood recovery

By Auditi Guha July 5, 2024, 7:57 am



Immigrant restaurateurs hit by July floods face continued hurdles to recovery

By Auditi Guha April 28, 2024, 6:01 am

WINOOSKI - VERMONT'S MOST DIVERSE



Vermont's multicultural liaisons help create bridges between new immigrant families and schools

By Auditi Guha July 22, 2022, 7:49 am



Winooski's new city manager is 'personally invested' in equity efforts

By Auditi Guha May 19, 2022, 2:47 pm



'It used to feel safe': 4 Muslim students share fears after shooting injured 3 Palestinian Americans

By Auditi Guha December 5, 2023, 6:52 pm

SAME RULES

Context
Balance
Fact checking
Fairness



Compassion
Care

DAILY NEWS



Trump order curbing access to gender-affirming care for youth creates ‘a lot of anxiety and a lot of fear’ in Vermont

By Auditi Guha January 30, 2025, 6:37 pm



‘An unconscionable betrayal’: Vermont groups scramble in wake of Trump order to halt refugee resettlement

By Auditi Guha January 23, 2025, 12:52 pm



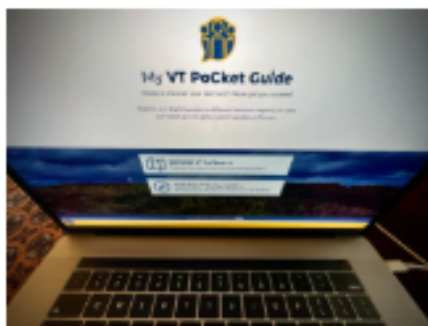
Suspension of federal funding hits Vermont refugee resettlement agencies and dozens of new arrivals

By Auditi Guha January 27, 2025, 7:22 pm



As the world’s largest displacement crisis continues in Sudan, refugees in Burlington quietly seek help

By Auditi Guha July 10, 2024, 5:28 pm



Organization launches guide for BIPOC Vermonters to explore, connect and overcome barriers

By Auditi Guha September 13, 2024, 6:40 pm



Civil and reproductive rights groups in Vermont make plans in advance of Donald Trump’s return

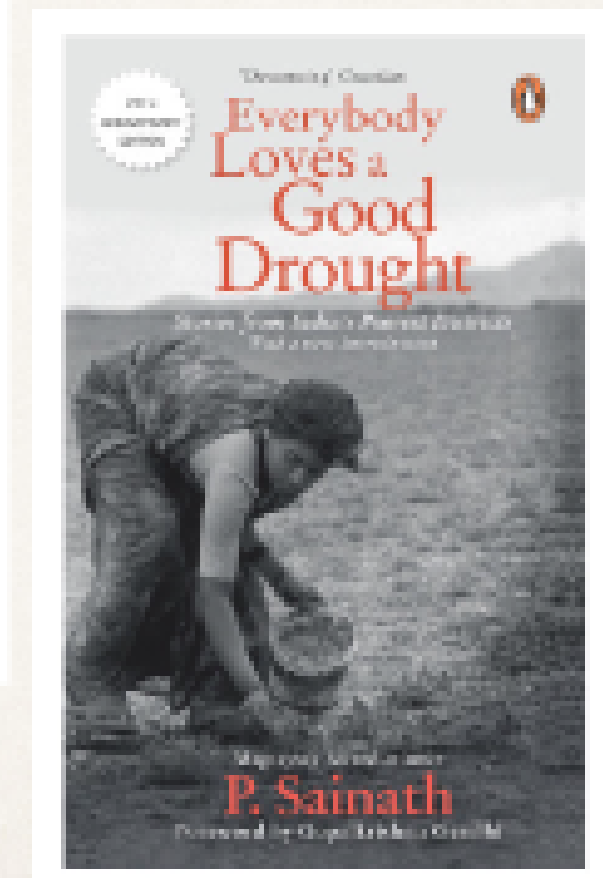
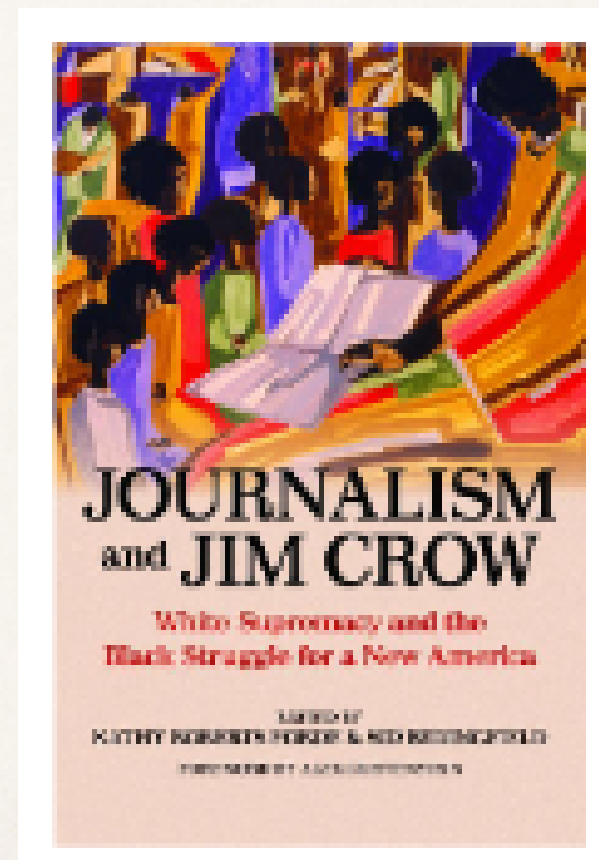
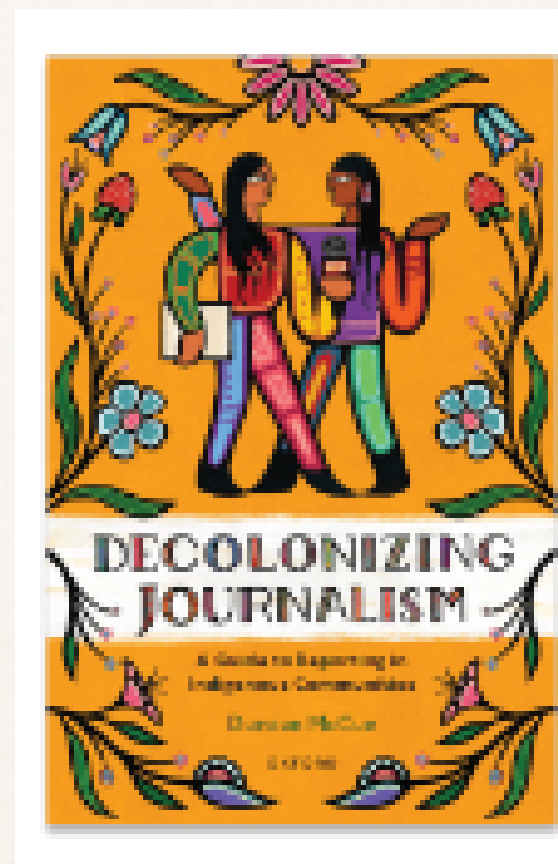
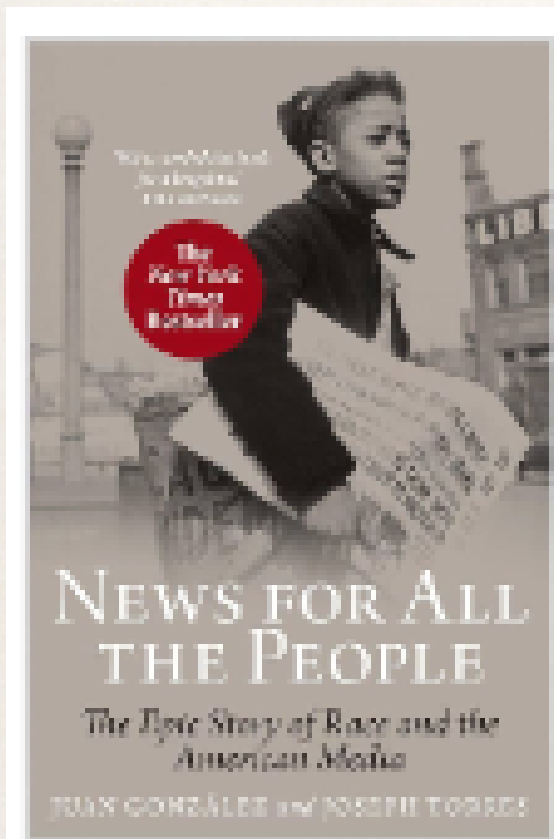
By Auditi Guha November 8, 2024, 4:12 pm



African women find community and healing at knitting group in Burlington

By Auditi Guha September 15, 2024, 8:06 am

Good Reads



Questions?

THANK YOU!

